

Updating data from DHIS2

Step-by-step guide · ~15 min + processing time

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You are logged into your FASTR instance with an admin account
- ☐ You know which month your current data stops at
- ☐ You know which month DHIS2 is filled up to

What this guide is for

Every month, facilities enter their reports into DHIS2 — and FASTR knows nothing about them until someone runs the update.

Since the latest platform version, that update takes **three moves**:

- 1. Import** the new months from DHIS2
- 2. Generate a results package** — this is what recomputes the analyses
- 3. Attach** the package to the projects

The example this guide follows: the last import stops at **November 2025**. DHIS2 now holds reports through **July 2026**. We will download **December 2025** → **July 2026**, then follow through.

The "Update data" button no longer exists. If you knew the old method — import, then click "Update data" in each project — forget it. The **results package** replaced it: all of a project's numbers come from a package, and you switch projects onto the most recent one.

The three moves

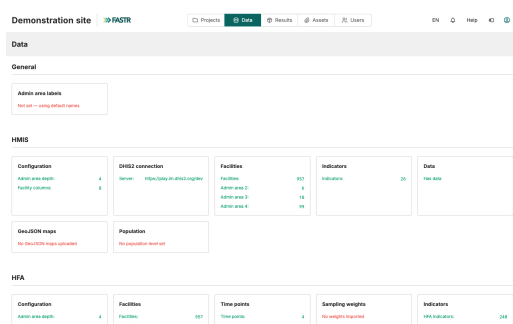
#	What you do	Where
1	Import the new months from DHIS2	Data → HMIS → Data → Imports
2	Generate a results package	Results → Generate new results package
3	Attach the package to the projects	Ticked directly in step 2, or project by project

The idea in one sentence: the import fills the data store, the package does the computing, and each project reads its numbers from the package attached to it.

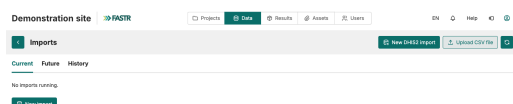
A tip that avoids surprises. Reports for recent months often change after the fact — facilities enter data late. When you choose the period to import, push the start back a few months. For our example: rather than December 2025 → July 2026, take **September 2025 → July 2026**. Re-downloaded months are simply refreshed with the up-to-date numbers.

1 Launch the import

1. Click **Data** in the top bar, then, in the **HMIS** section, the **Data** card.



2. Click **Imports**, then **New DHIS2 import**.



The wizard opens. It has four steps: **Indicators**, **Time**, **Config**, **Review & launch**. It uses the instance's stored DHIS2 connection (Data page, **DHIS2 connection** card); there is nothing to type.

3. Indicators — tick the indicators to download. For a routine update, the safe choice: **tick them all**, with the checkbox at the top of the list. Then **Next**.

Import HMIS data from DHIS2

Select the indicators to import

2 selected indicators

INDICATOR ID	LABEL	TYPE	DEFINED BY
☐ anc1_2	Antenatal care 1	Calculated	pentad
☒ anc4	Antenatal care 4	DHIS2 element	819ep52w05
☒ delivery	Institutional delivery	DHIS2 element	mu2w02_jm0
☐ pnc1_newborn	Postnatal care 1 (newborns)	DHIS2 element	0R18A1J0M0
☐ pnc1_mother	Postnatal care 1 (mothers)	DHIS2 element	5p1ar320f0
☐ bvg	BCG vaccine	DHIS2 element	9W1012gm0
☐ penta1	Penta vaccine 1	DHIS2 element	zhu02w02T7
☐ penta3	Penta vaccine 3	DHIS2 element	vY2102up08
☐ opd	Outpatient visit	Sum	bronchial_asthma, chronic_ear_infection, neoplasia_cancer, ytt040v0j4
☐ anc_test	ANC test	Calculated	(anc4 / anc1_2)
☐ test_bvg	Test BCG	Calculated	bvg
☐ test_opn	CPN Test	Calculated	(anc4 / anc1_2)
☐ cancer_cases	Total Neoplasia/Cancer cases	Sum	neoplasia_cancer
☐ chronic_ear_infections	Total number of chronic Ear infections	Sum	chronic_ear_infection
☐ bronchial_asthma	Total number of bronchial asthma	Sum	bronchial_asthma
☐ neoplasia_cancer	Neoplasia/Cancer	DHIS2 element	2204p0C08
☐ chronic_ear_infection	Chronic Ear Infection	DHIS2 element	4R0101_m000

Cancel Next

4. Time — choose **Now**, then **Next**.

Import HMIS data from DHIS2

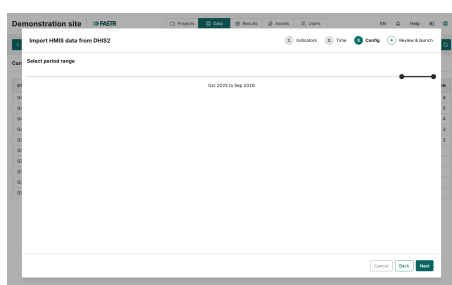
Now

Recurring

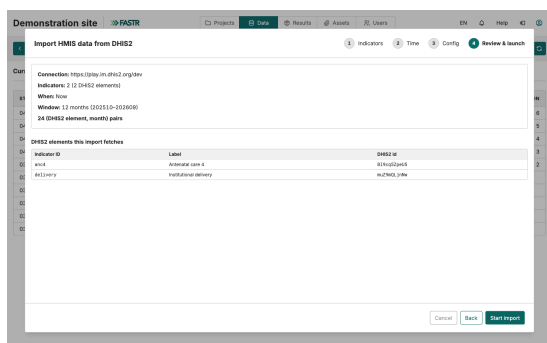
Cancel Next

Worth noting for later: the **Recurring** option schedules this import to repeat by itself, every month. Once the routine is well in hand, move 1 disappears from your list.

5. Config — set the **period range** with the two sliders: the window of months to download. For our example: **September 2025 → July 2026** — the new months, plus the margin for late entries.



6. Review & launch — reread the summary: the connection, the indicator count, the window. Then click **Start import**.

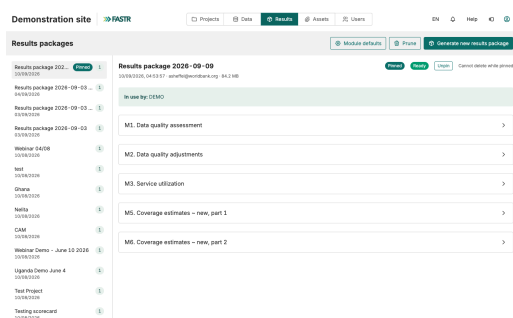


The import runs in the background — from a few minutes to much longer, depending on the window and the number of indicators. The **History** tab of the Imports page tells you when it is finished. **Wait for it to finish before move 2:** a package generated too early would compute on the old data.

2 Generate the results package

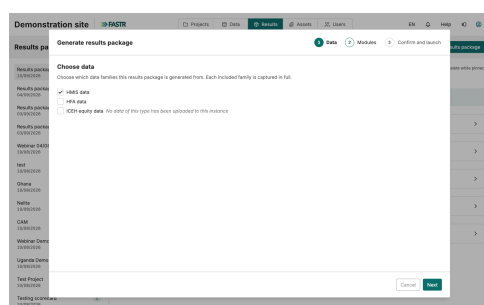
The new months are downloaded, but no analysis has recomputed. That is the package's job.

1. Click **Results** in the top bar. The **Results packages** page lists the existing packages, with each one's date and the projects using it.

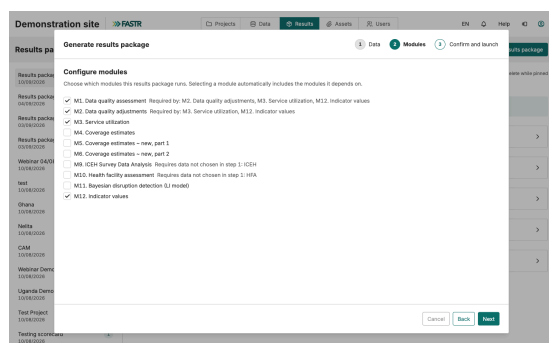


2. Click **Generate new results package**. The wizard has three steps.

3. **Data** — tick **HMIS data**. Then **Next**.



4. **Modules** — tick the analysis modules to run, the usual ones for your instance. If a module needs another one, FASTR adds it by itself. Then **Next**.



3 Attach the package to the projects

The attachment happens on the wizard's last step — move 3, built into move 2.

1. **Confirm and launch** — a label is suggested, with today's date. Keep it, or name the package more clearly: "Data through July 2026".
2. Under **Attach to projects**, tick every project that should switch to the new numbers. As soon as generation succeeds, those projects switch to the new package — with no further action from you.

The screenshot shows the 'Generate results package' wizard in the FASTR application. The wizard is at step 3, 'Confirm and launch'. The sidebar on the left lists several projects, including 'Results package 10/07/2026', 'Results package 04/09/2026', 'Results package 03/09/2026', 'Results package 08/09/2026', 'Webinar 04/09 10/09/2026', 'test 10/08/2026', 'Chane 10/08/2026', 'Nefza 10/08/2026', 'CAM 10/08/2026', 'Webinar Demo 10/08/2026', 'Uganda Demo 10/08/2026', 'Test Project 10/08/2026', and 'Testing scenarios 10/08/2026'. The main panel contains the following sections:

- Confirm and launch**: A 'Label' field with the text 'Results package 2026-09-21'.
- Data**: A field with the text 'HMS data'.
- Modules**: A list of modules: 'M1. Data quality assessment', 'M2. Data quality adjustments', 'M3. Service utilization', and 'M12. Indicator values'.
- Attach to projects**: A section with the text 'These projects switch to the new package when generation succeeds. Optional — you can also attach it later from a project's Results package tab.' and a checkbox labeled 'CAM'.

At the bottom of the main panel are three buttons: 'Cancel', 'Back', and 'Launch generation' (which is highlighted in green).

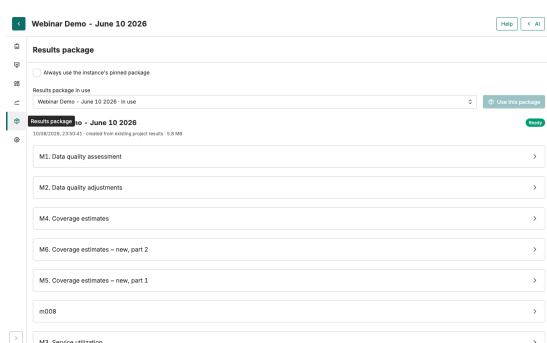
3. Click **Launch generation**. It runs in the background; progress shows on the Results packages page.

Forgot a project? No problem. Open that project, go to its **Results package** tab, pick the new package from the list and click **Use this package**. FASTR first shows you what the change would affect, then switches. A project you don't switch keeps showing the old numbers — without warning anyone.

Check that the new months are in

Open one of the attached projects and display a chart you know well — a monthly series. The time axis should now run through **July 2026**.

In the project's **Results package** tab, you can also check at a glance which package is in use and how old it is — the line under its name gives the generation date.



The setting that simplifies everything: the pinned package. On the **Results** page, the **Pin** button designates the instance's reference package. In each project, the **"Always use the instance's pinned package"** checkbox makes that choice follow automatically — but it is **not on by default**: tick it once in each project concerned. From then on, the monthly routine comes down to: import, generate, **pin**. The projects follow by themselves.

If a number doesn't add up

- **A recent month is missing everywhere** — the import didn't cover that month, or it wasn't finished when the package was generated. Check the Imports **History** tab, then generate a new package.
- **The month is imported but missing from one project** — that project stayed on an old package. Open its **Results package** tab and switch it.
- **A recent number differs from DHIS2** — facilities entered data after your import. Run another import including that month, then a new package.

Recap

Move	Where	Effect
Import from DHIS2	Data → HMIS → Data → Imports	Downloads the new months into the instance
Generate a results package	Results → Generate new results package	Recomputes all analyses on the up-to-date data
Attach to projects	Ticked at generation, or the project's Results package tab	The projects show the new numbers

Our example, in short: data stopped at November 2025, DHIS2 filled through July 2026. Import **September 2025 → July 2026** (margin included), wait for it to finish, generate a package "**Data through July 2026**" ticking the projects concerned. The charts now run through July 2026.

The good habit: make these moves on a fixed date, every month, once DHIS2 entry has stabilized. And two settings make them nearly automatic: the **Recurring** import (move 1) and the **pinned** package with projects set to "always follow" (move 3).